

Sixth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Sexta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: baptismal death and eucharistic feeding

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Dominus fortitudo plebis suae</i> (Ps. 27)	Strength and shepherding	St. Augustine on Psalm 27; St. Leo the Great on Christ the shepherd	God strengthens by saving, blessing, ruling, and feeding his inheritance.
Collect	Increase of religion; nourish and guard the good	Growth in grace	St. Gregory the Great on pastoral nurture; St. Francis de Sales on devotion	Grace implants love, feeds what is good, and guards what has begun to live.
Epistle	Rom. 6:3-11	Buried with Christ; walk in newness of life	St. Cyril of Jerusalem, Mystagogical Catecheses; St. Ambrose, On the Mysteries	Baptism is not a symbol only; it is death with Christ ordered to a new life.
Gospel	Mark 8:1-9	Feeding of the four thousand	St. Bede on Mark; St. Augustine on the loaves	The baptized are fed in the wilderness, sustained by Christ before they faint on the way.
Offertory	<i>Perfice gressus meos</i> (Ps. 16)	Steady steps in God's paths	St. Benedict on perseverance	The offering asks that baptismal life not wobble into old servitude.
Communion	<i>Circumibo et immolabo</i> (Ps. 26)	Sacrifice of jubilation	St. Thomas Aquinas on Eucharistic sacrifice	The fed people become a praising people; Eucharist turns survival into jubilation.

Thread	Synthesis
Baptism and Eucharist	Romans names the death and resurrection given in baptism; Mark shows Christ feeding those who follow him in the desert. Initiation and sustenance belong together.
Wilderness and Church	The crowd has remained three days with Christ. The Fathers hear paschal overtones: the people who share his death receive bread for the journey.
Prayer focus	Renew baptismal renunciation by refusing one old servitude and receiving today's duties as food for new life.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Sexta post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Cyril of Jerusalem, Mystagogical Catecheses; Ambrose, On the Mysteries; Bede on Mark 8.